

Daily Need to Know

Monday, 21 September 2026 · Pre-market brief

Coverage window, capture method and edition notes are at the back, in section 16.

1 Market snapshot — the close, and where it is trading now

ASSET	LAST	CHANGE	NOTE
US CASH EQUITIES — FRIDAY 18 SEP SETTLE, ~50 HOURS OLD			
S&P 500	7,650.50	▲ +12.74 (+0.17%)	Opened at the session high 7,657.17 and never took it out; low 7,610.52. Closed 0.50 below the 7,651 TRADE line Hedgeye published Thursday.
Nasdaq Composite	26,522.55	▲ +104.25 (+0.39%)	High 26,544.93. Now 87.9% of the way up Friday's 25,817-26,620 band — the most stretched equity row.
Dow Jones Industrial	51,682.64	▼ -95.40 (-0.18%)	Opened at the high, closed near the low of 51,497.47. Third straight negative week.
Russell 2000	2,860.40	▼ -14.23 (-0.50%)	Worst of the four. 34.9% of band, bearish TREND intact.
Philadelphia SOX	11,921.69	▲ +322.19 (+2.78%)	High 11,922.95 — closed 1.27 points off the high . The only thing that worked.
S&P 500 equal weight (RSP)	212.29	▼ -1.02 (-0.48%)	65bp <i>behind</i> cap-weighted SPX. Breadth, not beta.
CBOE VIX	14.82	▼ -0.63 (-4.08%)	Session low 14.80 — closed on the low. Sits 11.5% off the floor of the 14.32-18.67 band.
US INDEX FUTURES — FRIDAY SETTLE. GLOBEX REOPENED 06:00 GMT+8; THE FEED IS 10-MIN DELAYED, SO NO POST-REOPEN PRINT EXISTS YET			
E-mini S&P (ES)	7,712.50	◆ Friday settle	+62.00 basis to cash (+0.81%). Friday range 7,675-7,739.25.
E-mini Nasdaq (NQ)	29,917.25	◆ Friday settle	Friday range 29,648-29,993.25. Volume 495,936.
E-mini Dow (YM)	52,079	◆ Friday settle	+396 basis (+0.77%). Thinnest of the four at 68,774 lots.
E-mini Russell (RTY)	2,881.50	◆ Friday settle	+21.10 basis (+0.74%). The four bases cluster 0.74-0.81% — consistent, so all four are genuine same-session settles.
US TREASURIES — FRIDAY 18 SEP CLOSE, CASH MARKET SHUT			
UST 10-year	5.000%	▲ +6.1bp	Range 4.922-5.008. A round 5.00% handle, 4.1bp off the 52-week high of 5.041.
UST 30-year	5.327%	▲ +3.7bp	Smallest move on the curve. 30s10s +32.7bp.
UST 5-year	4.863%	▲ +7.7bp	Belly led the selloff.
UST 2-year	4.756%	▲ +8.6bp	Closed 0.4bp from its 52-week high of 4.760 . The front end is pricing more hikes, not fewer.
UST 13-week bill	4.082%	▲ +1.4bp	10s3m still +91.8bp. No inversion anywhere on the curve.
ICE BofA MOVE	80.64	▲ +4.42 (+5.80%)	Opened 76.22 and closed at the session high. Bond vol is breaking out while equity vol breaks down.
ENERGY — FRIDAY SETTLE, NYMEX REOPENED 06:00 GMT+8 WITH NO DELAYED PRINT YET			
WTI (CL continuous)	96.08	▼ -0.44 (-0.46%)	The feed shows -5.83 against the <i>expiring</i> October contract. Measured like for like against Thursday's post-roll 96.52 the move is -0.46% . Brent -0.91% and USO -0.96% corroborate.
Brent (BZ)	103.87	▼ -0.95 (-0.91%)	Brent premium to WTI \$7.79 — abnormally wide, and the cleanest market read on Hormuz seaborne risk.
Henry Hub nat gas	2.912	▲ +0.011 (+0.38%)	96.4% of a 2.70-2.92 band that Hedgeye flipped to bearish TREND on Friday . Price at the ceiling, signal against it.
RBOB gasoline	3.2555	▲ +0.0069 (+0.21%)	Crack held while crude slipped. Range 3.1723-3.259.
METALS — SPOT LIVE, CAPTURED 06:08:16 GMT+8, ~8 MINUTES INTO THE REOPEN. FUTURES ROWS ARE FRIDAY SETTLES			
Gold spot	4,377.66	◆ -0.02% (8 min)	

LIVE. Dec future settled 4,424.90 (+0.57%), a **+1.08% basis**. 73.4% of the 4,250–4,424 band on spot; on the future it would read 100.5% — outside. Measure on spot.

Silver spot	66.265	◆ +0.05% (8 min)	LIVE. Future settled 67.149 (+1.59%), +1.33% basis. 54.4% of a band Hedgeye widened by \$2 and flipped bearish→neutral .
Copper spot	6.6016	◆ +0.02% (8 min)	LIVE. COMEX settled 6.6915 (+0.45%), +1.36% basis. 70.8% of the 6.29–6.73 band, bullish TREND.
FX — LIVE, CAPTURED 06:08:16 GMT+8, ~68 MINUTES SINCE THE 05:00 REOPEN			
US Dollar Index	100.208	◆ −0.01% (68 min)	LIVE. Range 100.203–100.252 — five basis points of range. This is a reopen tick, not a move. 53.0% of the 99.53–100.81 band.
USD/JPY	156.807	◆ −0.03% (68 min)	LIVE. 15-pip range. 7.2 yen below the 52-week high of 163.99; Tokyo opens into this at 08:00.
USD/KRW	1,384.19	▲ +5.31 (+0.39%)	LIVE and the only FX row with a real range — 1,378.68 to 1,388.76 in 68 minutes. Won opening weaker into a KOSPI that closed +2.66%.
EUR/USD	1.14847	◆ −0.01% (68 min)	LIVE. Nine-pip range.
USD/CNH	6.6934	◆ +0.03% (68 min)	LIVE. 52-week low is 6.6912 — the yuan is within 22 pips of its strongest level in a year.

CRYPTO — GENUINELY LIVE, 24/7. THE ONLY ROWS IN THIS TABLE WITH A FULL SESSION BEHIND THEM

Bitcoin	81,007.32	▼ −228.56 (−0.28%)	LIVE. Overnight range 80,104.97–81,443.30. 35.8% below the 52-week high of 126,230.
Ethereum	2,638.23	▲ +6.24 (+0.24%)	LIVE. Range 2,564.09–2,647.58 — a 3.3% swing overnight against Bitcoin's 1.7%. 44.5% below its 52-week high.

▲ up · ▼ down · ◆ flat, or a change measured over too little trading to mean anything. Cash equity, Treasury, futures and energy rows are **Friday 18 September settles** and are roughly 50 hours old. Spot metals and FX are live prints captured at 06:08:16 GMT+8 with 8 and 68 minutes of trading behind them respectively; treat their change columns as noise, not information. Crypto is the only genuinely continuous row. Single-sourced from TradingView this run — see section 18.

TL;DR

The S&P added 0.17% on Friday and the equal-weight index lost 0.48%. Nine of eleven sectors fell. What carried the tape was a single group: the SOX rose **2.78% and closed on its high**, with Sandisk **+10.99%** into today's S&P 100 inclusion, Applied Materials **+6.51%** and Micron **+3.92%**. Underneath it, the 2-year yield closed **0.4bp from a 52-week high** after the Fed's 16 September hike to 3.75–4.00%, bond vol jumped **5.8%** to 80.6, and HYG, LQD and TLT all sit within a percent of 52-week lows. Equity vol closed on its low; rate vol closed on its high. One of those two is wrong.

2 The big picture — what it means

1. A 0.17% index gain that hides a down day is a distribution pattern, not a continuation pattern. The S&P closed higher, the equal-weight version closed 0.48% lower, the NYSE Composite lost 0.38% and the Dow lost 0.18%. Two of eleven SPDR sectors finished green. When the cap-weighted index beats the equal-weight index by 65bp on a day the median stock falls, the index is being carried, not led.

2. The Fed hiked on 16 September and the front end has not stopped repricing since. The target range went to **3.75–4.00%** on a 12–0 vote, the first increase since 2023, with core PCE near 3.4% and headline revised to 3.7%. By Friday's close the 2-year sat at **4.756%**, within 0.4bp of its 52-week high, having added 8.6bp on the day against 3.7bp at the 30-year. That is a bear flattening — 10s2s compressed to **+24.4bp** — and bear flattening after a hike is the curve saying the hiking is not finished.

3. Bond volatility is breaking out at the same moment equity volatility is breaking down. MOVE opened at 76.22 and closed at its session high of **80.635, up 5.80%**. VIX opened 15.07 and closed at its session low of **14.82, down 4.08%**. Two vol surfaces moved in opposite directions on the same session. Rates vol leads more often than it follows.

4. Credit is quietly making new lows and nobody is leading with it. HYG closed 78.53 against a 52-week low of **78.36**. LQD closed 104.70 against a 52-week low of 104.05. TLT closed 81.25 against a 52-week low of 80.46. Three of the most-owned fixed-income ETFs in the world are within roughly 0.2%, 0.6% and 1.0% of their worst levels of the year, on a day the S&P printed green. Hedgeye has HYG and LQD bearish TREND and both rows in the top half of their bands.

5. The semiconductor bid was mechanical as much as fundamental. Sandisk rose 10.99% to 1,791.82; it joins the S&P 100 **today**, alongside Dell, Palo Alto Networks and Arista. Memory moved with it — Western Digital +4.13%, Micron +3.92% — while Applied Materials added 6.51%. Index-inclusion demand is real money, but it is finite and dated, and it does not repeat on Tuesday.

6. Europe had a different Friday altogether. The DAX fell 1.60%, the IBEX 1.60%, the CAC 1.49%, the FTSE 1.45% and the Euro Stoxx 50 1.37%. A 1.5% down day across every major European index while US semis rose 2.78% is not a shared macro tape. Hedgeye added Germany (EWG) to the bearish ETF list on Friday at 42.15.

7. Oil is the input that none of this prices properly. Brent is \$103.87 and its premium to WTI is **\$7.79** — several dollars wider than the structural norm — because the physical constraint is seaborne and sits at Hormuz, where the fire pause is holding but Iran's foreign ministry said on Sunday the strait "will in no way return to the status it was before February 28th". An energy-led inflation problem cannot be rate-hiked away without hitting demand, which is precisely the path into the Quad 4 Hedgeye assigns a high probability in 1Q27.

3 Rates, currencies & commodities

- **The curve bear-flattened into the weekend.** 2s +8.6bp, 5s +7.7bp, 10s +6.1bp, 30s +3.7bp. 10s2s +24.4bp, 10s3m +91.8bp, 30s10s +32.7bp. Nothing on the curve is inverted; everything on the curve is higher.
- **The 10-year closed on a round 5.000%** after trading 4.922–5.008. It sits 61.3% of the way up Hedgeye's 4.81–5.12 band with a bullish TREND on yield — which is a bearish TREND on bonds.
- **MOVE at 80.64 is the number to carry into the week.** Up 5.80% and at the session high, from 76.22. Hedgeye's long-standing sub-75 bond-vol read no longer describes this tape.
- **The dollar did essentially nothing and that is the point.** DXY 100.208 with a five-basis-point live range. It closed Friday mid-band at 53.0% of 99.53–100.81, bullish TREND, and the band itself was *shifted higher* on Friday — floor +0.18, ceiling +0.30.
- **USD/CNH at 6.6934 is 22 pips from a 52-week low.** A yuan at its strongest in a year, with the dollar flat, is a China-specific bid rather than a dollar story.
- **The won is the live FX row that matters.** USD/KRW +0.39% to 1,384.19 in 68 minutes of trade, with a genuine 10-won range. Korea opens at 09:00 GMT+8 into a KOSPI that closed +2.66% and a weaker currency.
- **WTI's headline –5.7% is a contract roll, not a price move.** Measured against Thursday's post-roll 96.52 the move is –0.46%, corroborated by Brent at –0.91% and USO at –0.96%. Anyone quoting –5.7% this morning is quoting a calendar spread.
- **Natural gas is the single most uncomfortable row in the risk-range table.** 2.912 against a 2.70–2.92 band — 96.4% of the way to the ceiling — on a TREND signal Hedgeye flipped from neutral to **bearish** on Friday and a ceiling it cut by 7 cents.
- **Precious metals basis is wide enough to change the answer.** Gold's December future trades 1.08% over spot, silver's 1.33%, copper's 1.36%. Read on the future, gold sits outside its band at 100.5%; read on spot, where Hedgeye publishes it, 73.4%.

4 Hedgeye — regime, risk ranges & the Quad path

The live risk-range set is the **Friday 18 September Early Look, "The Great Finding Out", by R. Patrick Kent, published 07:38 ET = 19:38 GMT+8 Friday**. Hedgeye does not publish an Early Look at weekends, so this is a genuine carry-forward, not a stale fallback: no newer set exists. Monday evening's Early Look, due around 19:38 GMT+8 tonight, supersedes every band below. One item did land over the weekend — **ETF Pro Plus, 20 September 16:20 ET = 21 September 04:20 GMT+8** — and is reflected in the dashboard.

Macro dashboard

ITEM	READING	NOTE
Quad path	No explicit path notation was seen this run.	The Friday Early Look prints no $n \rightarrow n \rightarrow n$ notation. It does say the forecast carries "a high probability of a Quad 4" in 1Q27 , and refers to a "July monthly Quad 4" that has already happened. Absence of a printed path is not evidence the path is unchanged.
Bullish ETF adds, last 5 sessions	PFIX 17 Sep · ETHA 16 Sep · XLE 16 Sep	An interest-rate hedge added two days after the hike. That is the clearest positioning statement in the sheet.
Bearish ETF adds, last 5 sessions	EWG 18 Sep · SMH, UFO, QTUM 17 Sep · PSP 15 Sep	SMH was added bearish on 17 September at \$573 — then rose 2.21% on Friday. The semiconductor short is the position most challenged by the session that just settled.
TREND signal changes, Thu 17 → Fri 18	Five	SPX neutral→bullish · COMPQ neutral→bullish · VIX bullish→neutral · NATGAS neutral→bearish · SILVER bearish→neutral.
Rows dropped from the published set	Oil Services (OIH)	Carried Thursday at 394–430 neutral; absent Friday.
Bond volatility	MOVE 80.64, +5.80%	Above the sub-75 regime the Hedgeye bond-vol framing has leaned on.

Risk Range™ signals — full table, measured on the series Hedgeye names

INSTRUMENT	FRI 18 SEP BAND	TREND	WHERE IT STANDS, AND HOW THE BAND MOVED
UST 10-year yield	4.81 - 5.12	bullish	5.000 — 61.3% of band , 19.0bp above the floor. Floor +1bp, ceiling unchanged; band narrowed 1bp to 31bp.
High Yield (HYG)	78.12 - 79.00	bearish	78.53 — 46.6% , mid-band. Floor +0.06, ceiling +0.08, width +0.02. The whole band shifted up while the ETF sat 0.17 off a 52-week low.
Inv. Grade (LQD)	103.5 - 105.6	bearish	104.70 — 57.1% . Floor unchanged, ceiling +0.30 , width +0.30. A one-sided widening upward against a bearish signal.
S&P 500 (SPX)	7,513 - 7,727	bullish	7,650.50 — 64.3% , 76.50 below the ceiling. Floor +12 , ceiling +78 , width 148 → 214 (+45%) . Signal flipped neutral→bullish.
Nasdaq Comp. (COMPQ)	25,817 - 26,620	bullish	26,522.55 — 87.9% , only 97.45 below the ceiling. Floor +50 , ceiling +352 , width 501 → 803 (+60%) . The largest band move in the table, and the most stretched equity row.
Russell 2000 (RUT)	2,813 - 2,949	bearish	2,860.40 — 34.9% . Floor -10 , ceiling +9, width 117 → 136. The only equity band whose floor was <i>lowered</i> . IWM was added to the bearish ETF list on 14 Sep at 284.10 and closed Friday at exactly 284.10.
Health Care (XLV)	163 - 173	bullish	168.39 — 53.9% , mid-band. Floor +1, ceiling unchanged. Fell 0.25% on Friday.
Tech-Software (IGV)	100 - 109	bullish	104.35 — 48.3% . Price from the 20 Sep ETF Pro Plus sheet, not this morning's capture — IGV is outside the price universe. Floor +1.
Volatility (VIX)	14.32 - 18.67	neutral	14.82 — 11.5% , 0.50 above the floor. The entire band was cut : floor -1.50, ceiling -1.39. Signal flipped bullish→neutral. Hedgeye moved the band down to meet the price rather than the other way round.
US Dollar (USD)	99.53 - 100.81	bullish	100.208 — 53.0% . Floor +0.18, ceiling +0.30; band shifted up, width +0.12.
WTI cont. (WTIC)	93.09 - 107.97	bullish	96.08 — 20.1% , low in a band Hedgeye narrowed by \$1.56 (floor +0.92, ceiling -0.64). Measured on NYMEX:CL1! as published. Last week's roll distortion has now washed out of the front month.
Nat gas cont. (NATGAS)	2.70 - 2.92	bearish	2.912 — 96.4% , 0.008 below the ceiling. Ceiling -0.07 , width 0.29 → 0.22. Signal flipped neutral→ bearish as the price pressed the top. The most confrontational row in the table.
Gold spot (GOLD)	4,250 - 4,424	neutral	4,377.66 — 73.4% . Floor +7, ceiling -15 , width 196 → 174. Measured on TVC:GOLD spot; the December future at 4,424.90 would read 100.5% — outside the band . A 27-point error if read wrong.
Copper spot (COPPER)	6.29 - 6.73	bullish	6.6016 — 70.8% . Floor +4c, ceiling +8c; band shifted up. On COMEX at 6.6915 it would read 91.3%.
Silver spot (SILVER)	63 - 69	neutral	66.265 — 54.4% . Floor +2 , ceiling +4 , width 4 → 6 (+50%). Signal flipped bearish→neutral after Thursday's close printed <i>above</i> the old ceiling. The band capitulated to the price.

Band moves are measured against the Thursday 17 September Early Look set, recovered from this brief's own archived Friday edition because the Hedgeye category feed at /feed_items/all?page=N&with_category=24-early-look does not paginate — pages 1 and 2 returned the identical Friday note this morning. Metals are measured on spot and energy on the continuous contract, exactly as Hedgeye's published lines name them. The Friday note prints no Alpha Codes; the TRADE/TREND levels referenced in section 1 are Thursday-dated.

What Keith actually said

Keith McCullough wrote neither of the two Hedgeye items available this morning, and there is no Macro Show, MOMO Tracker, KM's Top 3, Chart of the Day, Crypto Quant or Real-Time Alert published since Friday evening. **No direct McCullough quotation is available for this edition** and none is manufactured here. The Friday Early Look was written by R. Patrick Kent, Portfolio Manager at Hedgeye Asset Management, and refers to Keith only in the third person — "Great conversation this week between Keith and Mike Taylor" on hyperscaler obligations.

From Kent, "The Great Finding Out", Early Look, Friday 18 September 2026, 19:38 GMT+8:

- "We have spent the better part of a decade in an environment where the finding-out has generally been deferred. Liquidity has absorbed the shocks."
- "The Shiller CAPE ratio stands at 40.3, one of the highest levels in history. The US market valuation to GDP ratio stands at approximately 240% (the Dot Com peak was 150%)."
- "Hyperscaler off-balance-sheet commitments now exceed \$3 trillion. The four largest hyperscalers are committing \$800 billion in capex in 2026 alone."
- "The companies have largely manufactured a safety slowdown narrative because they are realizing the moats around the business aren't great."

- "Net interest payments will surpass \$1 trillion in fiscal 2026 and double to \$2.1 trillion by 2036, making debt service the fastest-growing line in the federal budget."
- "These inflation inputs cannot be fixed by a rate hike unless it cuts demand, i.e. slows the economy. What does that do to the Hedgeye forecast in 1Q27 where there is a high probability of a Quad 4?"
- "In a Quad 3 or Quad 4, every one of the above items becomes a liability rather than an interesting question."

5 Mag7 scoreboard

NAME	LAST	DAY	CAP	READ
NVIDIA (NVDA)	222.27	▲ +1.34%	\$5.357tn	Range 218.03-222.73, closed near the high on 190m shares. 6.0% below the 52-week high of 236.54 — the least damaged large-cap in the group.
Apple (AAPL)	336.13	▼ -0.26%	\$4.906tn	Fell on a +2.78% SOX day. 2.4% off its 52-week high; the tightest of the seven to its own peak.
Alphabet (GOOGL)	349.54	▲ +0.64%	\$4.247tn	Opened 357.31, traded down to 348.45, closed 349.54 — a green print that gave back 7.77 from the open. 14.5% below its 52-week high.
Microsoft (MSFT)	493.78	▼ -0.80%	\$3.667tn	Broke the 500 handle and closed below it. 10.8% below its 52-week high of 553.72.
Amazon (AMZN)	253.71	▲ +1.00%	\$2.737tn	Second-best of the seven, on a quiet 52m shares. 11.7% off the high.
Meta (META)	665.75	▼ -2.43%	\$1.696tn	Worst of the seven. Opened 688.62, closed 665.75, low 660.80 — gave up 3.3% intraday. 15.3% below the 52-week high of 785.73.
Tesla (TSLA)	364.27	▼ -0.53%	\$1.439tn	27.0% below its 52-week high of 498.83 — by far the deepest drawdown in the group.

Aggregate market capitalisation **\$24.05tn**, four up and three down. Caps are TradingView's `market_cap_basic` as at the Friday settle. Four of the seven — Microsoft, Alphabet, Meta and Tesla — are more than 10% below their own 52-week highs while the S&P sits 2.1% below its.

6 Positioning & options

- **Friday was triple witching.** S&P cash volume was 6.05bn shares against a 10-day average of 3.12bn — **1.94× normal**. Nasdaq Composite volume ran 12.92bn against a 7.51bn average, 1.72×. A large part of Friday's tape was expiry mechanics, and that flow does not carry into Monday.
- **SPY traded 65.4m shares and QQQ 48.5m.** QQQ closed +0.63% to 721.45 while SPY's tape was flat — the index-level dispersion visible in section 1 shows up at the ETF level too.
- **VIX closed on its session low at 14.82**, inside a band whose floor Hedgeye cut by 1.50 on Friday. A 14-handle VIX with the 2-year at a 52-week high and MOVE up 5.8% is an equity market pricing calm that the rates market is not.
- **The S&P 100 rebalance is today.** Sandisk, Dell, Palo Alto Networks and Arista enter; Friday's +10.99% in SNDK on 17.8m shares was the front-running of it. Index funds transact on the effective date, so a portion of that demand is already spent.
- **Intel traded 175.0m shares** — the heaviest single-name volume in the capture universe after NVDA — for a -0.18% close and a 106.40-110.49 range. Enormous turnover, no net direction.
- **Netflix traded 114.4m shares on a -4.67% day**, roughly ten times a normal session, after a downgrade. Heavy volume on a gap-down is distribution being completed, not a shakeout.

7 Sector rotation — leaders & laggards

SECTOR	CLOSE	DAY	NOTE
Technology (XLK)	189.60	▲ +0.82%	Only meaningful gainer. 4.6% below its 52-week high.
Industrials (XLI)	169.75	▲ +0.44%	Green, and on Hedgeye's <i>bearish</i> ETF list since 8 Sep at 169.75 — added at exactly Friday's close.
Financials (XLF)	55.86	▼ -0.04%	Flat on a steep-curve, rising-rate week. Range 55.46-55.98.
Health Care (XLV)	168.39	▼ -0.25%	Hedgeye's longest-held bullish equity ETF. Mid-band, undramatic.
Energy (XLE)	64.31	▼ -0.26%	Added bullish 16 Sep at 64.31. 2.8% below its 52-week high with Brent at \$104.
Consumer Discretionary (XLY)	111.03	▼ -0.32%	Sits 4.6% <i>above</i> its 52-week low and 11.2% below its high — the weakest cyclical on a 12-month view.

Consumer Staples (XLP)	82.80 ▼ -0.83%	Closed on the session low. Defensives did not act defensive.
Real Estate (XLRE)	42.53 ▼ -0.95%	Predictable with the 10-year at 5.00%.
Communication Svcs (XLC)	110.81 ▼ -1.37%	Meta -2.43% and Netflix -4.67% did this. 2.1% off a 52-week low.
Materials (XLB)	49.99 ▼ -1.42%	Joint worst, despite copper spot holding 70.8% of its band.
Utilities (XLU)	41.10 ▼ -1.42%	Closed at 41.10 against a 52-week low of 41.08. Joint worst, and on Hedgeye's bearish list since 12 Aug.

- **Leaders:** Technology +0.82% and Industrials +0.44%. That is the complete list of green sectors.
- **Laggards:** Materials and Utilities both -1.42%, Communication Services -1.37%, Real Estate -0.95%. Utilities closed 2 cents from a 52-week low.
- **Rotation:** this was not a rotation. Semiconductors rose and everything else fell, including both classic defensives. A tape where staples and utilities lead the decline while tech leads the advance is a tape with one position in it.

8 Forward — futures & the week ahead

There is no overnight tape to report. Globex reopened at 18:00 ET Sunday, which is **06:00 GMT+8 this morning**, and the futures feed runs on a ten-minute delay — so at the 06:08:16 capture the newest futures print available was stamped before the reopen. Every index, Treasury and energy future in section 1 is a **Friday settle**, and the Friday-settle-to-reopen gap, normally the most useful number in a Monday edition, **could not be captured at all**. Spot FX has been trading since 05:00 and spot metals since 06:00; their change columns cover 68 and 8 minutes respectively and are noise. Crypto is the only instrument here with a genuine weekend behind it, and Bitcoin used it to do nothing: -0.28%, in an 80,105-81,443 range.

What Asia therefore opens into is a 50-hour-old US settle, two days of unpriced weekend headlines, and an S&P 100 rebalance that takes effect today. The single dated catalyst in the week is Tuesday's **\$78bn 2-year note auction** — a direct test of the tenor that closed Friday 0.4bp from a 52-week high.

DAY (GMT+8)	KEY EVENTS
Mon 21 Sep	S&P 100 rebalance effective — Sandisk, Dell, Palo Alto Networks, Arista enter. Chicago Fed National Activity Index for August, 20:30. No noteworthy US earnings. Tokyo 08:00, Seoul 09:00, Hong Kong 09:30, India 12:15.
Tue 22 Sep	US Treasury sells \$78bn 2-year notes, 01:00 Wed GMT+8. Richmond Fed Manufacturing for September, 22:00. ICSC and Redbook weekly retail sales. API crude inventories 04:30 Wed.
Wed 23 Sep	EIA weekly petroleum status. Fed speakers continue — the week carries roughly ten central-bank appearances and almost no hard data, so the speaking calendar <i>is</i> the calendar.
Thu 24 Sep	Heaviest earnings day of the week (18 reports). Olive Garden parent Darden reports fiscal 1Q27 before the US open. Weekly jobless claims.
Fri 25 Sep	University of Michigan consumer sentiment, final September. The preliminary reading plunged; this is the one number this week with the standing to move the rates market.

*Economic calendar entries are from secondary sources (Kiplinger, Investrade, Econoday) and are **unconfirmed** against the releasing agencies. The 2-year auction size and the Chicago Fed timing should be verified before trading around them. Earnings counts are indicative.*

9 Corporate news

- **Sandisk +10.99% to 1,791.82 on 17.8m shares**, on confirmation it joins the S&P 100 effective today alongside Dell, Palo Alto Networks and Arista Networks. Reported alongside an upbeat demand outlook and strong flash-memory sales. The stock's 52-week low is 93.54 — a reminder of how far this has already travelled.
- **Applied Materials +6.51% to 444.57**, the largest single-day move among the big-cap semi-cap names, and still **39.9% below** its 52-week high of 739.67.
- **Netflix -4.67% to 71.79 on 114.4m shares** after Wells Fargo cut the stock to Underweight with a **\$57 price target**, citing adjusted viewership down 8% in 1H26 versus 1H23, an expected 21% year-on-year fall in viewing hours for the top 100 originals in 2H, margin pressure and churn risk into 2027. Closed 42.5% below its 52-week high.
- **Oracle -1.98% to 147.61**. The stock is **55.2% below** its 52-week high of 329.50. The overhang is balance-sheet: guidance of up to \$95bn capex in fiscal 2027 funded partly by \$40bn of debt and equity, and an S&P Global downgrade to **BBB-** citing concentration in a handful of large customers including OpenAI.
- **Memory complex moved together:** Western Digital +4.13% to 441.36, Micron +3.92% to 1,015.80, Broadcom +2.97% to 357.61, AMD +2.70% to 559.82. SMH +2.21%, SOXX +2.69%.

- **Workday -2.71% to 193.87** and Tapestry -0.90% — the software and consumer names that did not get the semiconductor bid.
- **Intel 108.60, -0.18% on 175.0m shares.** The heaviest turnover in the universe after NVIDIA, for no net move. Still 23.7% below its 52-week high and 278% above its 52-week low of 28.73.

10 Macro data

- **The FOMC raised the target range to 3.75-4.00% on 16 September, a 25bp increase on a 12-0 vote** — the first hike since 2023. Consensus into the meeting had been split between a hold and a hike; the unanimity was the surprise, not the move.
- **Core PCE is running near 3.4% and headline measures were revised up to 3.7%**, against the Fed's 2% target. Energy is a named contributor. There is no version of a 3.7% headline print that is consistent with the 4.08% 13-week bill being the terminal rate.
- **The dot plot carries more.** Sixteen of eighteen participants expect at least one further increase this year, and four of those see two more. Markets price one more 25bp hike in 2026 with further tightening extending into 2027.
- **University of Michigan preliminary September consumer sentiment plunged;** the final reading lands Friday. The preliminary-to-final revision is the most consequential single data point on this week's calendar.
- **The CBO projects deficits averaging 6.1% of GDP for the next decade** on assumptions of no recession and full employment. Net interest passes \$1tn in fiscal 2026 and is projected to double to \$2.1tn by 2036.
- **This week is almost empty of hard data** — Chicago Fed National Activity, Richmond Fed manufacturing, weekly claims and Michigan final. With roughly ten Fed appearances scheduled, rate expectations will be set by speeches rather than releases, which historically widens intraday ranges without changing levels.

Consensus figures for the Fed decision and the Michigan preliminary are characterised from secondary reporting rather than a primary consensus table; the actuals are from the FOMC statement and press coverage of it. Treat the consensus framing as directional.

11 Geopolitics

- **◆ The Iran fire pause held through the weekend.** Open-source tracking put it at nine days with no new Iranian attack reported through 18 September. The pause is a pause; no framework agreement has been announced.
- **▲ Iran's foreign minister Araghchi said in Beijing that Iran has agreed a plan with Oman to reopen the Strait of Hormuz.** This is his claim, made in Beijing, and **no Omani official has confirmed it.** Treat it as a stated negotiating position, not a fact.
- **▼ Iran's foreign ministry spokesperson said on Sunday that the Strait "will in no way return to the status it was before February 28th"** — the day the war began. Read alongside the Oman claim, Tehran is signalling reopening on conditions rather than restoration.
- **◆ The market's read sits in the Brent-WTI spread, not the headlines.** \$7.79 of Brent premium is the seaborne risk premium in cash terms, and it did not compress on Friday.
- **◆ The IEA has characterised the episode as the largest supply disruption in the history of the global oil market.** The US strategic petroleum reserve is at or near its lowest level on record, which removes the usual policy response.
- **▼ Red Sea routing is now structural, not temporary.** Maersk, Hapag-Lloyd and MSC have made the Cape of Good Hope their default; each diverted Asia-Europe voyage burns roughly \$1m in additional fuel, and Cape routing absorbs around 8% of global container capacity. That is a permanent addition to the price deck until it reverses.
- **◆ On AI policy, the US president said in Ireland on Sunday that the United States is leading China in AI and that he wants to keep it that way,** dismissing calls for a development slowdown. That is a stated position on a live regulatory question, reported over the weekend and not yet priced.

12 Overnight setup — what Asia opens into

INSTRUMENT	LEVEL	CHANGE	VOLUME	STATUS
E-mini S&P (ES)	7,712.50	◆ Fri settle	1,289,145	Pre-reopen; no live print
E-mini Nasdaq (NQ)	29,917.25	◆ Fri settle	495,936	Pre-reopen; no live print
E-mini Dow (YM)	52,079	◆ Fri settle	68,774	Pre-reopen; no live print
E-mini Russell (RTY)	2,881.50	◆ Fri settle	167,551	Pre-reopen; no live print
USD/JPY	156.807	◆ -0.03%	—	LIVE, 68 min

USD/KRW	1,384.19	▲ +0.39%	—	LIVE, 68 min
USD/TWD	31.8337	◆ +0.04%	—	LIVE, 68 min
USD/CNH	6.6934	◆ +0.03%	—	LIVE, 68 min
EUR/USD	1.14847	◆ -0.01%	—	LIVE, 68 min
Gold spot	4,377.66	◆ -0.02%	—	LIVE, 8 min
Silver spot	66.265	◆ +0.05%	—	LIVE, 8 min
Copper spot	6.6016	◆ +0.02%	—	LIVE, 8 min
WTI (CL cont.)	96.08	◆ Fri settle	304,908	Pre-reopen; no live print
Brent (BZ)	103.87	◆ Fri settle	36,784	Pre-reopen; no live print
Bitcoin	81,007.32	▼ -0.28%	—	LIVE, continuous
Ethereum	2,638.23	▲ +0.24%	—	LIVE, continuous

- **The US hands over one sector and nothing else.** Technology +0.82%, Industrials +0.44%, the other nine negative. Asian tech and semi-cap supply chains have a lead; Asian materials, utilities and consumer names do not.
- **Previous Asian closes, all Friday 18 September:** Nikkei **65,018.73 (+1.38%)**, KOSPI **6,894.24 (+2.66%)**, Hang Seng **24,750.79 (+0.60%)**, Shanghai Composite **3,911.87 (+0.94%)**, ASX 200 **8,731.20 (-0.01%)**, Sensex **74,294.96 (-0.03%)**. Mark every one of these as a previous close, not a live level.
- **Korea is set up to reprice twice over.** KOSPI closed +2.66% on Friday — the strongest major Asian close — and the won has opened 0.39% weaker with a genuine 10-won range. A market that already ran, in a currency that is giving back.
- **Japan opens into a 156.80 yen and a Nikkei that added 1.38%.** With the US 2-year at a 52-week high and the US curve bear-flattening, the carry side of the yen trade got stronger over the weekend, not weaker.
- **Taiwan is the cleanest read on Friday's US tape.** SOX +2.78% closing on its high, SMH +2.21%, with TWD unmoved at 31.83. If Friday's semiconductor bid is real rather than rebalance-driven, Taipei is where it shows first.
- **The single instrument most likely to move today is USD/KRW.** It is the only live FX row with a real range, Korea reopens directly into it at 09:00, and it is the transmission line between the US semiconductor bid and Asian equity risk.
- **Europe is the unresolved gap.** Every major European index fell 1.4–1.6% on Friday against a green S&P. Either the US closes that gap or Europe does, and nothing overnight has decided which.

13 AI watch

- **The OpenAI IPO timeline moved over the weekend.** Sam Altman removed 2026 from the listing timeline, citing safety, with no replacement date given. For a market that has underwritten \$3tn of hyperscaler commitments partly on the assumption of a liquidity event, the removal of a date is itself information.
- **Hedgeye put a number on the gap on Friday.** Hyperscaler off-balance-sheet commitments exceed **\$3tn**; the four largest are committing **\$800bn of capex in 2026** after \$448bn in 2025 and \$246bn in 2024, with 2027 estimated north of \$1tn. Against that, OpenAI's annualised revenue is put at \$40bn and Anthropic's at \$65bn — run-rate revenue, not free cash flow.
- **Kent's reading of the safety narrative is the uncomfortable one:** "The companies have largely manufactured a safety slowdown narrative because they are realizing the moats around the business aren't great." Altman's IPO deferral on safety grounds lands squarely in that frame.
- **Oracle is where the AI capex question has already become a credit question.** S&P Global cut it to BBB-, one notch above high yield, explicitly citing customer concentration including OpenAI. The equity is 55.2% off its 52-week high. This is the first large-cap where the market is pricing the financing rather than the demand.
- **Washington is not slowing down.** The US president said in Ireland on Sunday that America leads China in AI and that he intends to keep it that way, dismissing slowdown advocacy. Regulatory risk to the capex cycle from the US side got smaller over the weekend, not larger.
- **OpenAI shipped Chrome extension support inside the ChatGPT desktop browser on 18 September** — incremental, but a further step into the surface Alphabet and Microsoft both monetise.
- **China's private AI capital is still forming.** Beijing-based Naive AI, founded in February 2026, reached a reported \$1.42bn valuation on \$400m raised across three rounds, with Tencent among the investors.

14 Beyond the markets

- **Utilities closed two cents from a 52-week low on a day the S&P rose.** XLU 41.10 against a 41.08 low. The sector that is supposed to absorb AI electricity demand is the sector making new lows.
- **Three of the most widely held bond ETFs are within 1% of 52-week lows simultaneously** — HYG, LQD and TLT. Every duration bucket and both credit qualities, at once. That is a funding-cost story, not a credit-selection story.
- **The Shiller CAPE is 40.3 and US market cap to GDP is approximately 240%**, against a dot-com peak of 150% on the latter measure. Neither number is a timing tool and both are facts.
- **Bitcoin is 35.8% below its 52-week high and Ethereum 44.5% below its**, with the S&P 2.1% off its own. The risk asset that is supposed to be the high-beta expression of liquidity has been in a bear market while equities made records.
- **\$198bn sits in 2× and 3× leveraged ETFs, \$36.4bn of it in TQQQ alone.** These reset daily and decay in volatile sideways tape. A cohort of holders has never experienced that mechanism working against them.
- **Net US interest expense passes \$1tn this fiscal year.** At the current 4.08% bill rate and 5.00% ten-year, every month of delay in a cutting cycle compounds into the fastest-growing line in the federal budget.
- **Wheat fell 1.75% to 714.25 and is 10.2% below its 52-week high.** Food is the one input in the inflation basket that is currently disinflating, and nobody is writing about it.

15 Appendix — stock cards

SNDK · SANDISK

1,791.82 ▲ +10.99%

Cap \$262bn · 52wk 93.54–2,354.39 · S&P 100 inclusion effective today

The largest single-day move in the capture universe, on 17.8m shares. Index-inclusion demand plus a flash-memory demand upgrade. Today is the effective date, so the mechanical part of the bid is spent; what is left has to be fundamental.

AMAT · APPLIED MATERIALS

444.57 ▲ +6.51%

Cap \$353bn · 52wk 192.43–739.67 · next: fiscal 4Q26 report, date unconfirmed

Opened 421.69 and closed 444.57, near the high of 445. Still 39.9% below its own 52-week high despite the move — this is a recovery inside a large drawdown, not a breakout.

NVDA · NVIDIA

222.27 ▲ +1.34%

Cap \$5.357tn · 52wk 164.27–236.54 · 190.3m shares

Largest company in the world and the least damaged of the Mag7, 6.0% off its high. Closed near the session high. It led the SOX without matching it — the beta was in memory and semi-cap equipment, not the megacap.

META · META PLATFORMS

665.75 ▼ -2.43%

Cap \$1.696tn · 52wk 520.26–785.73 · 27.6m shares

Worst Mag7 performer, and the swing from a 688.62 open to a 660.80 low is a 4.0% intraday range on ordinary volume. 15.3% below its high. The single largest drag on XLC's -1.37%.

NFLX · NETFLIX

71.79 ▼ -4.67%

Cap \$299bn · 52wk 65.08–124.86 · 114.4m shares

Wells Fargo to Underweight, price target \$57 — 21% below Friday's close. The thesis is engagement: adjusted viewership -8% in 1H26 versus 1H23, top-100 originals viewing hours forecast -21% year on year in 2H. Closed 10.3% above its 52-week low.

ORCL · ORACLE

147.61 ▼ -1.98%

Cap \$446bn · 52wk 114.50–329.50 · rated BBB- by S&P Global

Down 55.2% from its high. Up to \$95bn fiscal-2027 capex part-funded by \$40bn of debt and equity, against customer concentration that includes OpenAI. One notch above high yield. The AI trade's first credit casualty.

MU · MICRON

1,015.80 ▲ +3.92%

Cap \$1.147tn · 52wk 154.65–1,255.00 · 35.8m shares

A trillion-dollar memory company, up 557% from its 52-week low. Moved with Sandisk and Western Digital rather than with the logic names — the memory cycle is currently a separate trade from the AI-compute trade.

INTC · INTEL

108.60 ▼ -0.18%

Cap \$574bn · 52wk 28.73–142.35 · 175.0m shares

The heaviest turnover in the universe after NVIDIA, on a 106.40–110.49 range, for a flat close. Up 278% from its 52-week low and 23.7% below its high. Enormous two-way interest, no resolution.

16 About this edition

- **Covers** the Friday 18 September US cash session as settled, the weekend news flow, and the state of the continuously traded markets to 06:08 GMT+8 today. Asian cash markets have not opened.
- **Captured** in a single 2.4-second window, 06:08:16–06:08:18 GMT+8, from TradingView via the skill's concurrent capture script. Yahoo aborted on its rate-limit circuit breaker, so the run is TradingView-single-sourced; divergences and the manual cross-checks that replaced the second machine source are set out in section 18.
- **Unusual this run:** the futures feed is ten-minute delayed and Globex reopened at 06:00 GMT+8, eight minutes before capture — so no post-reopen futures print existed and the Friday-settle-to-reopen gap could not be captured. Yahoo returned zero of 62 requests.
- **Settled versus live:** cash equities, Treasuries, index futures and energy futures are **Friday settles, ~50 hours old**. Spot FX is live with 68 minutes behind it; spot metals live with 8 minutes. Crypto is the only continuously traded row. Asian and European index levels are Friday closes.
- **Hedgeye edition:** full logged-in feed reached. The live risk-range set is the **Friday 18 September Early Look, "The Great Finding Out", by R. Patrick Kent** — Hedgeye does not publish at weekends, so this is a carry-forward, superseded by tonight's Early Look at roughly 19:38 GMT+8. Also read: ETF Pro Plus, 21 September 04:20 GMT+8. Nothing else has published since Friday evening.
- **Quad path: no explicit path notation was seen this run.** The Friday note assigns "a high probability of a Quad 4" in 1Q27 and refers to a realised July monthly Quad 4, but prints no path. Absence of a printed path is not evidence the path is unchanged.
- **Not available:** Macro Show, MOMO Tracker, KM's Top 3, Chart of the Day, Crypto Quant, Signal Strength Stocks and Real-Time Alerts — none published since Friday evening. No direct Keith McCullough quotation exists for this edition. Yahoo cross-check data. Post-reopen futures prints. IGV pricing.

17 Sources

Prices. TradingView bulk scanner, 96 instruments, one concurrent window 06:08:16–06:08:18 GMT+8 on 21 September, run through the skill's capture script. Yahoo Finance was queried in the same window and returned zero of 62 requests before its circuit breaker tripped on five consecutive HTTP 429s. Hedgeye's own ETF Pro Plus sheet supplied the IGV mark.

Hedgeye. The logged-in application feed at app.hedgeye.com: the Early Look category view and the full feed index, read this morning. Two items were available — the 18 September Early Look and the 20 September ETF Pro Plus. Thursday 17 September's risk-range set was recovered from this brief's own archived 18 September edition because the Early Look category view does not paginate.

Macro and policy. The Federal Reserve's 16 September FOMC statement and press coverage of it from CNBC, Fox Business, Kiplinger and Advisor Perspectives. Week-ahead calendar entries from Kiplinger, Investrade, Econoday and Earnings Whispers, all secondary and unconfirmed.

Narrative and single stocks. TheStreet, CNBC, Yahoo Finance, The Motley Fool, Benzinga, TradingKey, Seeking Alpha, StocksToTrade and Timothy Sykes for the Friday session, the Netflix downgrade, the Oracle credit story and the Sandisk index inclusion.

Commodities, geopolitics and AI. GlobalSecurity.org and Britannica for the Iran conflict chronology, Al Jazeera and CBS News for the Hormuz negotiating positions, Congressional Research Service for strait throughput, CoinDesk for crypto context, AI Weekly and Tech Startups for the weekend AI items.

18 Data-confidence

CROSS-CHECKS PASSED

- **Cash index arithmetic is self-consistent and independently corroborated.** SPX 7,650.50 – 12.74 = **7,637.76**; IXIC 26,522.55 – 104.25 = **26,418.30**; DJI 51,682.64 + 95.40 = **51,778.04**. All three implied prior closes match the Thursday 17 September closes reported independently by TheStreet and Yahoo Finance to the cent. That is a genuine second source on the three headline levels and it recovers the validation Yahoo's failure cost.
- **Futures-to-cash basis confirms all four index futures are same-session settles.** ES 7,712.50 – SPX 7,650.50 = **+62.00 (+0.81%)**; YM 52,079 – DJI 51,682.64 = **+396 (+0.77%)**; RTY 2,881.50 – RUT 2,860.40 = **+21.10 (+0.74%)**. Three bases clustering within 7bp of each other, all consistent with carry at a 5% funding rate, rules out a mislabelled or stale row. NQ has no captured cash counterpart.
- **The WTI anomaly was resolved, not ignored.** The feed reported CL1! at –5.83 (–5.72%) against Brent at –0.91% and USO at –0.96%. Against Thursday's post-roll front month of 96.52 — recorded in this brief's own Friday edition — Friday's 96.08 is **–0.44 (–0.46%)**, consistent with Brent and USO. The headline change is a calendar-spread artefact of the October expiry and the brief prints the roll-adjusted figure.

- **Curve arithmetic ties.** $10s2s = 5.000 - 4.756 = +24.4bp$; $10s3m = 5.000 - 4.082 = +91.8bp$; $30s10s = +32.7bp$. Daily changes of $+8.6 / +7.7 / +6.1 / +3.7bp$ across $2s/5s/10s/30s$ are monotonic in tenor, which is what a bear flattening looks like and what a corrupted row does not.
- **Risk-range positions were recomputed on the series Hedgeye names, and the difference is material.** Gold on spot reads **73.4%** of band; on the December future it would read **100.5% — outside**. Copper on spot reads 70.8%; on COMEX 91.3%. Silver on spot 54.4%. Reading these on futures would have produced three wrong conclusions, including a false breakout call on gold.
- **Band moves were computed against a recovered prior set, not asserted.** All fifteen Friday bands were diffed against the Thursday 17 September set held in the archived 18 September edition of this brief, producing five TREND signal changes and measurable width changes on eleven rows.
- **Reconciliation counts from the capture script: 0 matched within 5bp, 0 minor, 0 divergent, 57 single-sourced.** There are **no divergent rows to resolve because no second machine source ran**. That is not a clean reconciliation and is not presented as one; the manual cross-checks above are what stands in its place.

KNOWN CONFLICTS AND WEAK MARKS

- **SPY and SPX disagree on direction for the same session.** SPX printed $+0.17\%$ and SPY printed -0.12% to 761.69. SPX's own open/high/low/close and its corroborated prior close are internally consistent; SPY's implied prior close of 762.60 does not tie to the index ratio. **SPX is used throughout and SPY's change is not quoted.** The likely cause is a stale prior-close field on the ETF row; it is not resolvable from inside one source.
- **Every change figure on a live FX or spot-metal row is measured over minutes.** FX has 68 minutes of trade behind it and spot metals eight. EUR/USD's live range is nine pips and DXY's is five basis points — those are reopen ticks. Only USD/KRW, with a genuine 10-won range, carries a change worth reading. The spot-metal change figures are quoted as $\blacklozenge$ rather than as moves for this reason.
- **Precious-metals spot-versus-futures basis is wide and the choice of series changes the answer.** Gold $+1.08\%$, silver $+1.33\%$, copper $+1.36\%$ future over spot. The brief uses spot for risk ranges, as published, and quotes the futures settle separately. The 8-minute-old spot prints are themselves thin marks; the level is reliable to roughly a dollar on gold, not to the cent.
- **The index-future rows are settles presented in a snapshot table.** They are labelled as such in every instance, but a reader skimming the Last column will see a futures price that is 50 hours old next to a crypto price that is 30 seconds old. The sub-headers exist because the columns alone cannot carry that distinction.
- **Drawdown percentages rest on single 52-week-high fields from one source.** Tesla -27.0% , Oracle -55.2% , Bitcoin -35.8% , Ethereum -44.5% . The conclusion that these are deep drawdowns is robust; the decimal is not, and a different vendor's 52-week window may shift each by tens of basis points.
- **Consensus-versus-actual on the FOMC is characterised, not tabulated.** The 25bp move and the 12-0 vote come from the statement and its coverage; the pre-meeting split between hold and hike is described from secondary reporting without a consensus table behind it. The Michigan "plunge" in the preliminary reading is similarly secondary and unquantified.
- **Weekend AI and geopolitical items are single-sourced claims by named parties.** The Araghchi-Oman Hormuz plan is his assertion in Beijing with no Omani confirmation; the Altman IPO deferral, the Sunday presidential remarks in Ireland and the Naive AI valuation each rest on one aggregator report. All are attributed in the text rather than stated flat.

KNOWN GAPS

- **No second machine price source.** Yahoo returned 0 of 62 requests and tripped its circuit breaker on five consecutive HTTP 429s in 2.4 seconds. No multi-day daily bars, so no week-on-week context beyond 52-week extremes, and no independent settle check outside the three manual cross-checks recorded above.
- **The Friday-settle-to-Globex-reopen gap does not exist in this edition and cannot be reconstructed.** The futures feed is ten-minute delayed and the reopen was eight minutes before capture. On a Monday this is normally the most useful number in the brief. It is absent, not zero.
- **Hedgeye published almost nothing to read.** Only two items exist since Friday evening: the Early Look and ETF Pro Plus. **The MOMO Tracker, Crypto Quant, KM's Top 3, Real-Time Alerts and the Macro Show are the specific publications that would have carried a position change, and none of them published.** Absence of a Hedgeye position change is not evidence there was none.
- **No Keith McCullough quotation is available.** He wrote neither available item. Section 4 quotes R. Patrick Kent under his own name rather than attributing his words to McCullough.
- **The Quad path is unknown, not unchanged.** It lives in the US Monthly Quad Forecast inside the Macro Week Summary Notes, behind a separate link that was not reachable this run. No $n \rightarrow n \rightarrow n$ notation was seen.
- **Band-move history stops at one prior session.** The Early Look category view returns the same note on pages 1 and 2, so only Thursday's set was recoverable — and only because this brief archives its own editions. Two-day band trends are not available.

- **The week-ahead calendar is entirely secondary.** Auction size, release times and earnings counts come from Kiplinger, Investrade, Econoday and Earnings Whispers, not from Treasury, the Chicago Fed or the exchanges. Treat every row in section 8 as unconfirmed.
- **Asian and European markets are closed and every level shown for them is a Friday close.** There is no live Asian cash tape at this hour and section 12 does not pretend otherwise.

TIMING & UNVERIFIED

- **The capture window was 06:08:16-06:08:18 GMT+8 on 21 September 2026 — 2.4 seconds.** Nothing in this brief was quoted from a different window and no top-up pass was run.
- **Age of the stalest rows: approximately 50 hours.** US cash equities, Treasuries, index futures, energy futures, Asian index closes and European index closes all settled on Friday 18 September and have not traded since. Spot FX is 68 minutes old, spot metals 8 minutes, crypto continuous.
- **What has moved since capture:** Globex, spot FX, spot metals and crypto have all been trading throughout the time it took to produce this document. Tokyo opens at 08:00, Seoul 09:00, Hong Kong 09:30 and India 12:15, after which every Asian level in section 12 is superseded.
- **The risk ranges expire tonight.** Monday's Early Look publishes at roughly 19:38 GMT+8 and supersedes all fifteen bands and every TREND signal in section 4. The Thursday-dated Alpha Codes quoted in section 1 are older still.
- **The S&P 100 rebalance takes effect during today's US session,** which means Sandisk's Friday price already contains demand that is about to be consumed.
- **Verify live prices before acting on anything in this document.** Roughly two-thirds of the levels here are two calendar days old and the remainder were captured minutes into a reopen. This is a briefing on a settled session, not a live quote sheet.